Water Safety — Visual Guide

Year 7–8 Health & Physical Education · Big pictures · Clear words · Key ideas

📌 **Teacher note:** This resource uses large icons, simple language (approx. Year 4–5 reading level), and high visual content to make core Year 7–8 water safety concepts accessible for students with learning difficulties, EAL/D learners, and low-literacy students. Pair with oral explanation and the scenario activity cards for best results.

🏄 The 5 Water Safety Rules



RULE 1

Read the signs

Always check flags and warning signs before you swim.



RULE 2

Feet first

Never dive into water you don't know. Always enter feet first.



RULE 3

Stay in your depth

Only swim where you can touch the bottom if you need to.



RULE 4

Swim with a friend

Never swim alone. Always have someone with you.



RULE 5

Signal for help

If you need help, raise ONE arm up high and keep it there.

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🏁 Beach Flags — What Do They Mean?

🟥🟨

Red & Yellow Flags

SWIM HERE. A lifeguard is watching. This is the safest spot. Always swim between these flags.

🟥

Single Red Flag

DANGER. Conditions are very bad. Do NOT swim here. Expert swimmers only with extreme care.

🟧

Orange Windsock

NO INFLATABLES. Strong wind is blowing out to sea. Inflatables will blow away and can't come back.

🟪

Purple Flag

MARINE DANGER. Dangerous sea creatures are in the water. Do NOT enter.

🌊 Caught in a Rip? What to Do

A rip is a fast stream of water pulling out to sea. **Don't fight it!** If you swim against it, you will get too tired to survive.

1. 😌 **Stay calm. Don't panic.**
2. 🛟 **Float. Save your energy.**
3. ↔️ **Swim sideways — not back to shore.**
4. ↗️ **Angle back in when out of the rip.**
5. 🙋 **Raise ONE arm to signal for help.**

🩺 Emergency — DRS ABCD

Someone is hurt near water? Use DRS ABCD — in this order, every time.

D	R	S	A	B	C	D
⚠️	🤚	📞	🫁	💨	💓	⚡
DANGER Is it safe for you to help?	**RESPONSE** Tap & call their name	**SEND 000** Call for help NOW	**AIRWAY** Tilt head back	**BREATHING** Look, listen, feel	**CPR** 30 pushes + 2 breaths	**DEFIB** Use AED if available

🪢 Rescuing Someone — Throw, Don't Go

✅ DO THIS

- ✔ Call 000 first
- ✔ Throw a rope, towel, pool noodle, or anything that floats
- ✔ Talk to them — keep them calm
- ✔ Pull them in using what you threw
- ✔ Stay on the edge — don't go in

❌ DON'T DO THIS

- × Jump in after them if you're not trained
- × Panic — panicking wastes time
- × Try to grab their hand by leaning over
- × Assume someone else will help

⚠️ Hidden Dangers — Inland Waterways

🌿 **Hidden weeds trap legs**

🥶 **Cold water shocks the body**

🪨 **Rocks & logs under the surface**

🌊 **Fast currents after rain**

👁️ **No lifeguard watching**

📡 **No phone signal for 000**

✏️ Quick Check — What Do You Remember?

Question 1

Name the 5 SwimSafe rules in order:

Question 2

What do red and yellow flags mean?

Question 3

If you're caught in a rip — what should you do FIRST?

Question 4

What does DRS stand for in DRS ABCD?

Question 5

Why should you NOT jump in to rescue someone if you're not trained?

Question 6

Name ONE hidden danger at a river or dam:

Swim & Water Safety — Accessible Visual Guide · Year 7–8 HPE · Adapted for diverse learners

lsv.com.au · stjohnvic.com.au · beachsafe.org.au

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